



Notification Waiver Determination

SCM Financial Group - Strategic Wealth Services Group

Acquisition	SCM Financial Group Pty Limited (SCM) applied for a notification waiver in respect of its proposed acquisition of the business and client related assets of Strategic Financial Planners Pty Ltd (SFP), Strategic Accountants and Business Advisors Pty Ltd as trustee for the Strategic Accountants & Business Advisors Unit Trust (SABA), and Strategic Super Services Pty Ltd as trustee for the S3 Strategic Super Services Unit Trust (S3) (together, the Strategic Wealth Services Group), as described in the transaction documents provided as part of the application (the Acquisition).
Determination	The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission has determined under section 51ABV(1)(a) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) that the Acquisition is not required to be notified.
Date of determination	28 August 2026

Parties to the Acquisition	SCM provides financial planning, accounting and tax services, and lending services from its 2 offices in Surrey Hills (Victoria) and St Leonards (NSW). SCM is a wholly owned subsidiary of AZ Next Generation Advisory Pty Limited (AZ NGA). AZ NGA is an Australian professional services advisory company established in 2014 that owns a number of financial planning and accounting and tax businesses with operations and customers across Australia. AZ NGA is a subsidiary of AZ Aust Holdings Pty Ltd, whose major shareholders are funds managed by Oaktree Capital Management LP, a global investment management firm specialising in alternative investments, and Azimut Holding S.p.a., a global asset and wealth management business listed on the Milan Stock Exchange. The targets, SFP, SABA and S3 operate from one office in Surrey Hills (Victoria). SFP provides financial planning services, SABA provides accounting and business services, and S3 provides self-managed superannuation fund accounting services. SCM, AZ NGA and the Strategic Wealth Services Group all supply financial planning services and accounting and tax services.
Explanation for determination	In making this notification waiver determination, the Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (the ACCC) has considered the information provided with the notification waiver application and had regard to the factors in section 51ABV(2)(b) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) (the Act).

	Based on the information currently before it, the ACCC considers that the Acquisition is unlikely to give rise to any material lessening of competition. In particular: a. the parties' combined share in the supply of financial planning services and accounting and tax services in Melbourne, Victoria and across Australia is estimated to be low and the increase in share of supply arising from the Acquisition would be small b. there are alternative suppliers of financial planning services and accounting and tax services in Melbourne, Victoria, and nationally. In these circumstances, the ACCC does not consider it necessary to reach a concluded view on the likelihood of the notification thresholds being met. Given that material competition concerns are unlikely to arise, the ACCC has determined that the Acquisition is not required to be notified. The ACCC considers that the determination is consistent with the object of the Act and the interests of consumers in promoting competition. For more information about the ACCC's approach to considering notification waiver applications and to assessing competition effects more generally, see the ACCC's guidance on notification waivers and merger assessment guidelines.
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Determination made by Commissioner Williams pursuant to a delegation under section 25(1) of the Act